Elaine (Yilin) Wang
she/her/hers
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EDUCATION

Yale University
Ph.D. Candidate (Advisor: Dr. Julia Leonard) **Expected Jun 2029**
M.Sc. in Psychology **Jan 2026**
M.Phil in Psychology **Jan 2026**

University of Toronto
Honours B.Sc. **Jun 2023**
Psychology, Neuroscience, Physiology
Independent project: *The effect of effort-reward inconsistency on persistence in preschool children*
Advisor: Dr. Jessica Sommerville

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Cognitive Development | Motivation | Caregiving | Education

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Wang, E., Shachnai, R., & Leonard, J.A. (2026). *Overparenting shapes how children learn about the self from social comparison.* Talk presented at the Cognitive Science Society, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil.

Wang, E., Radovanovic, M., Sommerville, J. & Leonard, J.A. (2026). *Children integrate diverse social signals to infer the value of effort during performance plateaus.* Talk presented at the Cognitive Development Society, Montreal, CAN.

Wang, E., Shachnai, R., & Leonard, J.A. (2025). *Hidden costs of overparenting: Children feel worse about their abilities when adults take over for their peers.* Talk presented at the Cognitive Science Society, San Francisco, CA.

Wang, E., Radovanovic, M., Sommerville, J. & Leonard, J.A. (2025). *Preschoolers persist more when effort-based messages align with effort-based rewards.* Talk presented at the Society for Research in Child Development, Minneapolis, MN.

Wang, E., Radovanovic, M., Sommerville, J. & Leonard, J.A. (2024) *Practice what you preach: Consistent messages about the value of effort foster children's persistence.* Cognitive Development Society, Pasadena, CA.

Wang, E., Radovanovic, M., & Sommerville, J.A. (2023). *Practice what you preach: Children persist less when values and reward structures are inconsistent.* Flash talk presented at the Society for Research in Child Development, Salt Lake City, UT.

Wang, E. (2022). *Practice what you preach: Children persist less when values and reward structures are inconsistent.* Talk presented at the Psychology Undergraduate Research Club at the University of Toronto, Toronto, ON.

Radovanovic, M., Soldovieri, A., Solby, H., **Wang, E.**, Vorvis, J., Shirvani, J., & Sommerville, J.A. (2022). *Autonomy in problem-solving: Prioritizing exploration relates to increased persistence.* Talk presented at the International Congress on Infant Studies, Ottawa, ON.

CONFERENCE POSTERS

[+]*Indicates undergraduate mentee* | ** Indicates equal contribution*

Wang, E., Shachnai, R. & Leonard, J.A. (2026). *Overparenting leads peers to form negative self-beliefs.* Poster presented at Cognitive Development Society, Montreal, CAN.

Umaña, L.R.[+]*, **Wang, E.***, Sommerville, J. & Leonard, J.A. (2026). *Stakes reduce children's optimism about their abilities.* Poster presented at Yale University Undergraduate Research Conference, New Haven, CT.

Umaña, L.R.[+], **Wang, E.**, Sommerville, J. & Leonard, J.A. (2026). *Stakes reduce children's optimism about their abilities.* Poster presented at Yale University Undergraduate Research Conference, New Haven, CT.

Umaña, L.R.[+], **Wang, E.**, Sommerville, J. & Leonard, J.A. (2025). *Expecting less when it matters more: Children's optimism decreases in high-stakes environments.* Poster presented at Wu Tsai Undergraduate Fellowship Symposium, New Haven, CT.

Wang, E., Radovanovic, M., Sommerville, J. & Leonard, J.A. (2024). *Preschoolers persist more when effort-based messages align with effort-based rewards.* Poster presented at Curiosity, Information Seeking & Exploration Conference, Providence, RI.

Wang, E., Radovanovic, M., Sommerville, J. & Leonard, J.A. (2024). *Practice what you preach: Consistent messages about the value of effort foster children's persistence.* Poster presented at Cognitive Science Society, Rotterdam, NL.

Matorina, N., **Wang, E.**, Guliyev, J., Barense, M.B. (2023). *The contextualization of recent and remote autobiographical memories.* Poster presented at the Cognitive Neuroscience Society, San Francisco, CA.

INVITED TALKS

Social Learning Lab, Stanford University	**2026**
Writing about Science, Medicine, and the Environment, Yale College	**2025**

Levari Lab, Brown University **2025**

Writing about Science, Medicine, and the Environment, Yale College **2024**

Research Rounds, Yale Center for Emotional Intelligence **2024**

PUBLICATIONS

Wang, E., Shachnai, R.+, & Leonard, J.A. (2025). Hidden costs of overparenting: Children feel worse about their abilities when adults take over for their peers. *Proceedings of the 47th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society.*

Wang, E., Radovanovic, M., Sommerville, J., & Leonard, J.A. (2024). Practice what you preach: Consistent messages about the value of effort foster children's persistence. *Proceedings of the 46th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society.*

Jung, K., Meleca, S., Suhan, S., Tan, A., **Wang, E.** & Babineau, M. (2022). *Expect the unexpected: Studying language acquisition in small-scale societies.* International Congress on Infant Studies Baby Blog.

IN PREPARATION

Wang, E., Radovanovic, M., Sommerville, J. & Leonard, J.A. (under review). Preaching effort, rewarding performance: How conflicting social signals shape children's persistence.

Wang, E., Shachnai, R. & Leonard, J.A. (in prep). Overparenting shapes how children learn about the self from social comparison.

AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS & FELLOWSHIPS

Conference Travel Fund: $800 **2026**
Graduate School of Arts & Science, Yale University

Conference Travel Fund: $700 **2025**
Graduate School of Arts & Science, Yale University

Conference Travel Fund: $800 **2024**
Graduate School of Arts & Science, Yale University

Education Studies Grant: $5000 **2024**
Education Studies Program, Yale University

The Mcnab Scholarship In Psychology: $800 **2023**
Department of Psychology, University of Toronto

Ethel Treble and F. Louis Barber Travelling Scholarship: $2700 **2023**

Victoria College, University of Toronto

Victoria College Postgraduate Scholarship: $2500 **2023**
Victoria College, University of Toronto

George Mandler Research Fund: $700 **2022**
Department of Psychology, University of Toronto

NSERC Undergraduate Research Award: $7500 **2022**
Department of Psychology, University of Toronto

Dr. Lorus J. And Dr Margery J. Milne Scholarship: $5000 **2022**
Victoria College, University of Toronto

Salvatore and Marion (Cooper) Brancaccio Scholarship: $1000 **2022**
Victoria College, University of Toronto

Karl S. Bernhardt Scholarship: $1000 **2021**
Victoria College, University of Toronto

Teça Patricia (Court) Coles Scholarship: $1000 **2020**
Victoria College, University of Toronto

Dean's List Scholar, Faculty of Arts & Science **2020 - 2023**
Faculty of Arts & Science, University of Toronto

TEACHING

Graduate Writing Lab Fellow **2026 - Present**
Poorvu Teaching and Learning Center, Yale University

Teaching Fellow **Spring 2026**
Research Methods Writing Intensive, Yale University

Teaching Fellow **Fall 2025**
Developmental Psychology, Yale University

Teaching Fellow **Spring 2025**
Research Methods Writing Intensive, Yale University

Teaching Fellow **Fall 2024**
The Criminal Mind, Yale University

WORKSHOPS

Freeman, M. E. & **Wang, E. Y.** (2026, October 13). Writing a Research Paper from A to Z: Part II. *Poorvu Center for Teaching and Learning.*

Freeman, M. E. & **Wang, E. Y.** (2026, October 6). Writing a Research Paper from A to Z: Part I. *Poorvu Center for Teaching and Learning.*

Chughtai, M. K. & **Wang, E. Y.** (2025, July 17). Statement of Purpose & Curriculum Vitae Workshop. *Psychology Committee on Diversity, Equity, & Inclusion.*

Wang, E. Y. & Shi, K. M. (2024, October 30). Statement of Purpose & Curriculum Vitae Workshop. *Psychology Committee on Diversity, Equity, & Inclusion.*

DEPARTMENT & COMMUNITY INVOLVEMENT

Community Engagement Community Co-Chair **2024 - Present**
Department of Psychology, Yale University

Mentor **2023 - 2024**
Sneak Peek Mentorship Program, Yale University

Mentor **2022 - 2023**
Psychology Students' Association, University of Toronto

Secretary-General **2022 - 2023**
North American Model United Nations, University of Toronto

Translator **2021 - 2021**
COVID Speaks

Leader **2020 - 2021**
Victoria College Orientation, University of Toronto

Mentor **2020 - 2021**
UniFind, University of Toronto

Mentor **2019 - 2020**
Academic Success Center, University of Toronto

SKILLS

RStudio, Datavyu, JASP, Microsoft Office Suite, iMovie, Level-1 MRI Training, FMRIB Software Library, SPSS, Squarespace

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Cognitive Science Society, Society for Research in Child Development, Cognitive Development Society